

Workshop: Backing up your Data

Clone Me

Hard disk cloning is nothing but a process by which you create an image or clone of your hard disk for fast and easy recovery of the operating system during disasters. This image could either be stored on another hard disk or a CD. There are many hard disk cloning software available today, such as Drive Image PRO, Norton Ghost, Instant Recovery etc.

Some advantages of using hard disk clone software are:

PC Migration: When you shift between PCs or plan to upgrade to a new PC, you will need to swap disks while keeping the original configuration and software intact. Cloning software helps you take an image of the original hard disk so that after the swapping is done, the image can be used to restore the previous configuration.

Hard disk backups: Data backup is the most important task today for any individual or organisation. Data that is backed up can be referred to when some information is needed or during formatting of hard disk or a system crash. The data that is backed up is to be brought back to the original configuration of the system using the OS. The image created by the cloning software program helps in restoring the OS, which in turn can be used to recover backed-up data.

Disaster recovery: Disasters could occur due to power failures, virus attacks or various other reasons. During these times the hard disk has to be restored after formatting, and one cannot spend ages installing the OS and drivers all over again. The hard disk image stored in another partition or a CD can be used to restore the OS during disasters. Hard disk cloning can be effectively used wherever a large number of computers are used. Corporations are often required to install a consistent and tested environment on a large number of computers. Computer labs used as a place of experimentation and exploration, run a high risk of virus attacks and crashes. Testing labs require a basic test configuration to be restored

after every test. Thus hard disk cloning makes all these tasks in different organisations both manageable and reliable.

Norton Ghost 2003 Personal Edition is one of the most popular hard disk cloning software, and comes from the makers of Norton Antivirus, Symantec Corporation. It offers fast and easy cloning recovery for both corporate and individual users. It also provides unmatched flexibility, control and features additional standalone utilities such as GDISK. The workshop that follows will show you how hard disk cloning can be done using Norton Ghost 2003.

To create or clone an Image File on a Partition:

Open Norton Ghost through program files. Click on Backup to open the backup wizard. Click Next. The wizard asks you the source of the image (the hard disk or partition whose image is to be created). Select 'File' as destination, and not 'CD/DVD'. Next, browse to the other partition where the image has to be stored and give an appropriate name to the image file. The wizard then gives you the list of devices and drivers, which cannot be restored from the image. The next wizard shows an advanced settings window where the list of external devices and drivers, such as USB or FireWire is to be mentioned for later restoration. The image can also be password-protected using this option. Just click 'Next' if you do not use any USB or FireWire devices and don't want password-protection. Now, the wizard shows you a screen to tell you the interface that is used after the computer restarts in DOS mode. Click Next, and you will get information on disaster recovery. The wizard prompts you to create a recovery disk and gives you tutorials on how to go about doing it. Create a recovery disk as per the instructions and use it in case Windows fails to boot. The next screen is the task summary showing details of the source and destination. The wizard prompts you to save all data and close all applications and then click OK. The computer restarts



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